

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) | Microsoft Sentinel | Security Monitoring | Log Ingestion and Parsing | Threat Intelligence

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, security monitoring, log ingestion, and threat-informed detection across complex enterprise environments. I have hands-on technical ownership of Microsoft Sentinel, including data connector configuration, log parsing, analytics rule development using Kusto Query Language (KQL), workbook creation, and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook design. I also hold expert-level proficiency in CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and have led the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender deployment across an 8,000-user estate. I have a strong understanding of financial services security requirements, having delivered security engineering at HICX Solutions Ltd, a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech organisation, and I am well-versed in the threat actors, Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) relevant to financial services and regulated organisations. I am an effective remote collaborator with a proven ability to work independently and deliver security outcomes at pace without close supervision.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering and Log Management:** Microsoft Sentinel (data connectors, log ingestion, parsing, KQL analytics rules, workbooks, SOAR playbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; log source onboarding, normalisation, monitoring, and alert management
- **Security Monitoring and Detection:** SIEM alert triage and response, detection engineering, correlation rule development, anomaly detection, behavioural analytics; CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Microsoft Sentinel analytics
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender / Defender XDR
- **Incident Response and Threat Intelligence:** Incident response aligned to NIST 800-61; threat actor analysis and TTP mapping using MITRE ATT&CK framework; threat hunting informed by current adversary intelligence
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra Identity / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; vulnerability scanning, risk-based prioritisation, and remediation tracking
- **Security Tooling:** Mimecast email security gateway, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Tanium, Check Point Harmony, PowerShell scripting, Splunk/SPL
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- University of the Arts London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst/Engineer | March 2025 - Present
- Oversee the deployment and management of Microsoft Sentinel across the organisation, configuring data connectors, configuring log ingestion pipelines, developing KQL-based parsing rules and analytics detections, and maintaining workbook dashboards for operational visibility.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR platform, including agent deployment, log ingestion, event normalisation, custom detection authoring, and threat hunting operations using Falcon Insight.

- Monitor, triage, and respond to security alerts across SIEM, EDR, and email security gateway platforms, investigating events, correlating indicators, and executing containment and remediation actions.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting informed by current threat intelligence and adversary Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, identifying threats that evade automated controls.
- Lead security incident response aligned to NIST 800-61, performing root-cause analysis, forensic investigation, containment, eradication, and post-incident reporting for significant security events.
- Design and deploy SOAR automation using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and PowerShell scripting, automating alert enrichment, triage, and response for common threat patterns to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender across the estate, overseeing integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified telemetry and correlated alert management.
- Administer Microsoft Entra Identity / Azure AD Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and SSO configurations alongside BeyondTrust PAM for privileged account governance.
- Lead vulnerability management using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised reporting and coordinating remediation with technical teams.
- Manage Mimecast email security gateway, enforcing inbound/outbound filtering, anti-phishing policies, and data loss prevention rules.

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity
 Performed security monitoring and DEX alert management across enterprise log sources, investigating security events and escalating confirmed incidents in line with response playbooks. *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Developed and tuned SIEM correlation rules and analytics detections, improving detection fidelity and reducing false positive rates to manageable levels.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively analysing endpoint, network, and identity telemetry for indicators of compromise and threat actor activity.
- Supported log onboarding and ingestion processes, ensuring coverage of key data sources including endpoint, network, and identity within the SIEM environment.
- Administered Azure AD / Entra Identity IAM functions, managing access lifecycle, MFA rollout, and SSO integrations for staff and student populations.
- Supported vulnerability scanning operations using Nessus and AppCheck, triaging findings and coordinating remediation with infrastructure and application owners.
- Contributed to the BeyondTrust PAM onboarding programme, assisting with configuration, policy design, and privileged user training.

HCC Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) | IT Engineer, Security, Quality, and Infrastructure
 Delivered security engineering and regulatory software as a service (SaaS) in a cloud environment, implementing endpoint security, identity management, and network security controls appropriate to financial services risk requirements. *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Managed security monitoring, log management, and alerting activities, building foundational detection and response processes in a fast-paced technology business.
- Applied knowledge of financial services business processes and associated threat actors to align security controls to the organisation's risk profile and regulatory obligations.
- Coordinated vulnerability scanning and tracked remediation of identified weaknesses across cloud and on-premises infrastructure, supporting compliance with regulatory security requirements.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment at UAL, onboarding diverse log sources, developing a library of KQL analytics rules, and establishing automated SOAR response workflows that materially reduced MTTR.
- Led the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Defender for Identity deployment across an 8,000-user estate, integrating with Microsoft Sentinel for unified XDR telemetry and correlated incident management.
- Established a structured threat hunting programme using Microsoft Sentinel KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying previously undetected threat actor activity through hypothesis-led analysis of log and endpoint telemetry.

- Engineered and deployed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), eliminating standing privileged credentials and enforcing just-in-time access to reduce the privileged attack surface.
- Delivered a vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, achieving systematic identification and prioritised remediation of critical and high-severity findings across the estate.
- Developed PowerShell-based automation scripts and SOAR playbooks that automated alert enrichment and initial triage for high-volume alert categories, significantly improving analyst throughput and response consistency.

EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.), Environmental and Resource Engineering
- Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.), Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000-90,000 | Remote (UK)